Clothing and Airbase Material Culture

Selected reference material assembled for B-17 production support on Thorpe-Abbotts airfield design. This brief was intendedto help anchor an aspect everyday life on base.
The goal of this kind of reference work was to give artists and modellers context, and concrete visual material and help them to make the base feel lived-in.

1. Everyday Infrastructure Context

A photo shows rows of bicycle plinths and the surrounding space. This helps establish how ordinary infrastructure shaped movement around the base. Details like this are useful for environment dressing and for grounding historical spaces with believable routines. Bicycles were a common sight on bases and an invaluable way to economise on fuel consumption, but one might not have otherwise expected to see them without evidence. Also note the womans clogs.

2. Kitchen clogs - duty wear and practical economy

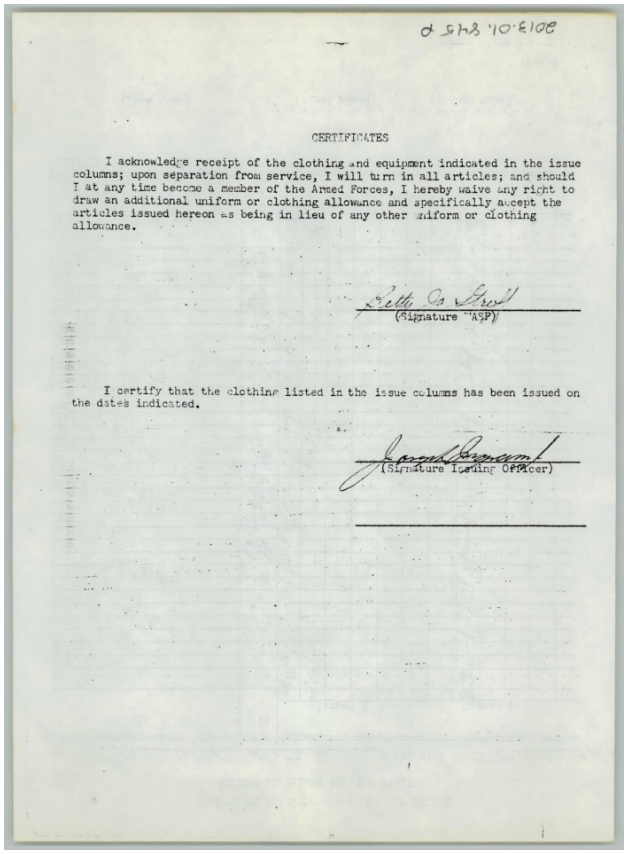
Wooden-soled clogs are a useful example of material rationing culture. They were a critical feature of civilian dress and an aspect of non-combat work on base. As noted in the provided reference lists, civilian women were not the only wearers of these wooden-soled shoes; W.A.A.F. cooks and kitchen personnel as well as quartermasters dealing with explosives also used clogs on duty to prolong and economise on service shoes and prevent sparks near volatile materials.

Left: unissued W.A.A.F. clogs in original packaging. Right: object reference showing the wooden soles, leather uppers, and rubber soles. Note tacking. (These were provided to our character artists to help them create accurately dressed examples of historical characters.)

Additional wear reference: Note silhouette, posture, and the footwear in everyday use - invaluable for the art team.

3. Issue records and equipment checklists

Archival checklists and QM records are invaluable to the designer. They show what people were issued in contemporary terms, how items were categorized, and quantitatively how prevalent objects were. This is useful for asset planning, character design, and space dressing, especially when trying to distinguish between everyday wear, specialist issue, and role-specific equipment.



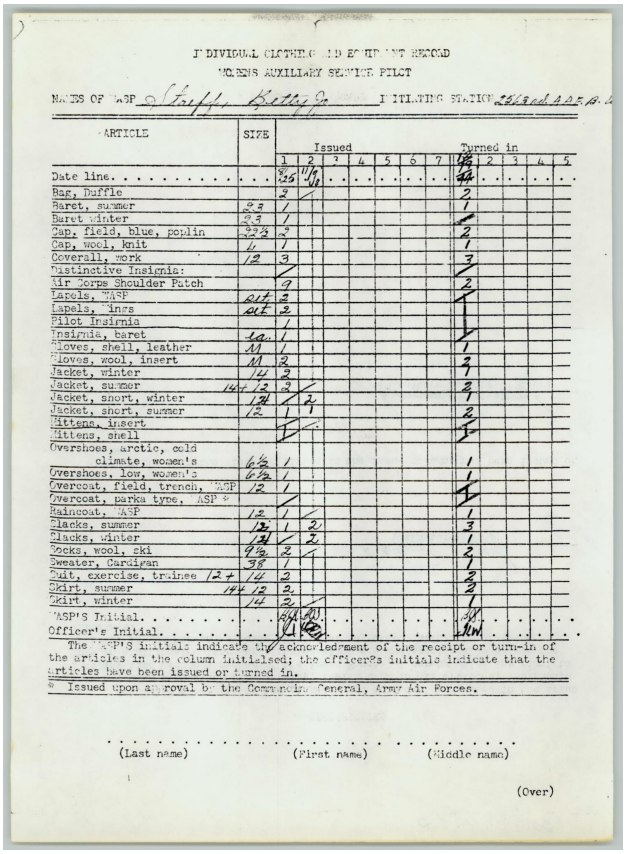
CERTIFICATES

I acknowledge receipt of the clothing and equipment indicated in the issue columns; upon separation from service, I will turn in all articles; and should I at any time become a member of the Armed Forces, I hereby waive any right to draw an additional uniform or clothing allowance and specifically accept the articles issued hereon as being in lieu of any other uniform or clothing allowance.

(Signature WASP)

I certify that the clothing listed in the issue columns has been issued on the dates indicated.

(Signature Issuing Officer)



INDIVIDUAL CLOTHING AND EQUIPMENT RECORD
WOMEN'S AUXILIARY SERVICE PILOT

NAMES OF WASP Stiff, Betty Jo INITIATING STATION Sweetwater AAF

ARTICLE	SIZE	Issued 1	2	3	4	5	6	7	Turned in 1	2	3	4	5
Date line		8/25	11/10						44				
Bag, Duffle		2							2				
Baret, summer	23	1							1				
Baret, winter	23	1							1				
Cap, field, blue, poplin	22½	2							2				
Cap, wool, knit	L	1							1				
Coverall, work	12	3							3				
Distinctive Insignia:													
Air Corps Shoulder Patch		9							2				
Lapels, WASP	pr	2							1				
Lapels, wings	pr	2							1				
Pilot Insignia		1							1				
Insignia, baret	pr	1							1				
Gloves, shell, leather	M	1							1				
Gloves, wool, insert	M	2							2				
Jacket, winter	14	2							2				
Jacket, summer	14+ 12	3							2				
Jacket, short, winter	12	1	2						1				
Jacket, short, summer	12	1							2				
Mittens, insert		1							1				
Mittens, shell													
Overshoes, arctic, cold climate, women's	6½	1							1				
Overshoes, low, women's	6½	1							1				
Overcoat, field, trench, WASP	12	1							1				
Overcoat, parka type, WASP *													
Raincoat, WASP	12	1							1				
Slacks, summer	12	1	2						3				
Slacks, winter	12	1	2						1				
Socks, wool, ski	9½	2							2				
Sweater, Cardigan	38	1							1				
Suit, exercise, trainee 12 +	14	2							2				
Skirt, summer 14 +	12	2							2				
Skirt, winter	14	2							1				
WASP'S Initial		BJS	BJS						BJS				
Officer's Initial		JM	JM						JM				

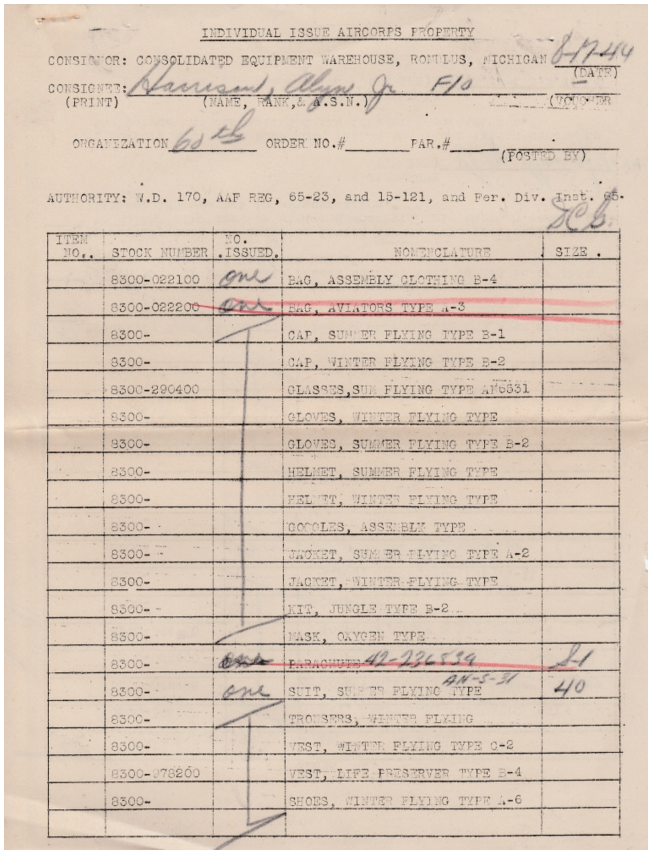
The WASP'S initials indicate the acknowledgment of the receipt or turn-in of the articles in the column initialsed; the officer?s initials indicate that the articles have been issued or turned in.

* Issued upon approval by the Commanding General, Army Air Forces.

(Last name) (First name) (Middle name)

(Over)

Examples of Quartermaster forms showing itemized women's auxiliary clothing records. These give artists and designers a sense of the kinds of objects that would be worn, and could expect to be found in personal rooms on the bases.



INDIVIDUAL ISSUE AIRCORPS PROPERTY

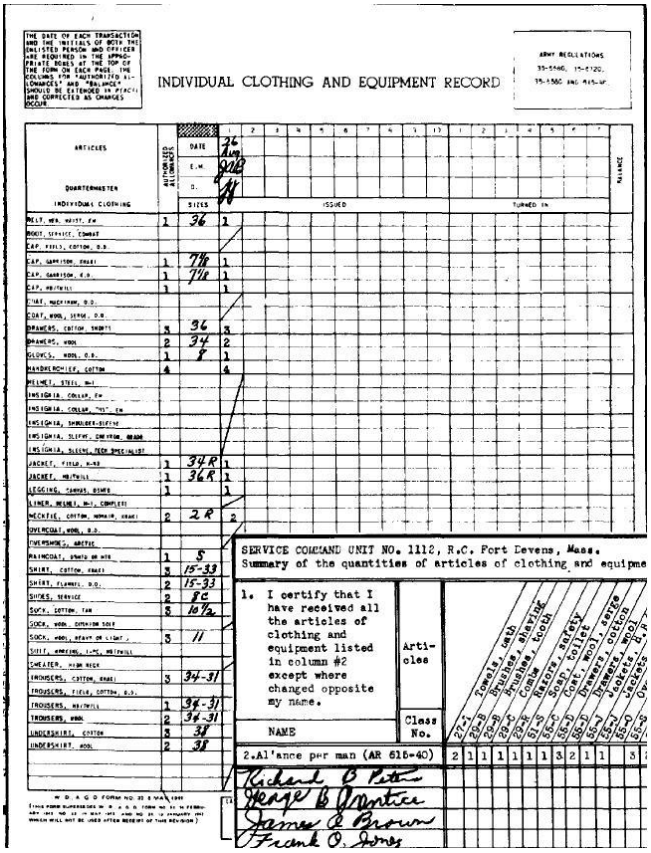
CONSIGNOR: CONSOLIDATED EQUIPMENT WAREHOUSE, ROMULUS, MICHIGAN 8-17-44 (DATE)

CONSIGNEE: Harrison, Alyn Jr F/O (NAME, RANK, & A.S.N.) (PRINT) (SIGNATURE)

ORGANIZATION 65 ab ORDER NO.# _____ PAR.# _____ (POSTED BY)

AUTHORITY: W.D. 170, AAF REG, 65-23, and 15-121, and Per. Div. Inst. 85. HCB

ITEM NO.	STOCK NUMBER	NO. ISSUED	NOMENCLATURE	SIZE
	8300-022100	one	BAG, ASSEMBLY CLOTHING B-4	
	8300-022200	one	BAG, AVIATORS TYPE A-3	
	8300-		CAP, SUMMER FLYING TYPE B-1	
	8300-		CAP, WINTER FLYING TYPE B-2	
	8300-290400		GLASSES, SUN FLYING TYPE AN6531	
	8300-		GLOVES, WINTER FLYING TYPE	
	8300-		GLOVES, SUMMER FLYING TYPE B-2	
	8300-		HELMET, SUMMER FLYING TYPE	
	8300-		HELMET, WINTER FLYING TYPE	
	8300-		GOGGLES, ASSEMBLY TYPE	
	8300-		JACKET, SUMMER FLYING TYPE A-2	
	8300-		JACKET, WINTER FLYING TYPE	
	8300-		KIT, JUNGLE TYPE B-2	
	8300-		MASK, OXYGEN TYPE	
	8300-	one	PARACHUTE 42-226559	S-1
	8300-	one	SUIT, SUMMER FLYING TYPE AN-S-31	40
	8300-		TROUSERS, WINTER FLYING	
	8300-		VEST, WINTER FLYING TYPE C-2	
	8300-076200		VEST, LIFE PRESERVER TYPE B-4	
	8300-		SHOES, WINTER FLYING TYPE A-6	



THE DATE OF EACH TRANSACTION AND THE INITIALS OF BOTH THE ENLISTED PERSON AND OFFICER ARE REQUIRED IN THE SPACE PROVIDED ON THE TOP OF THE RECORD ON EACH PAGE. THE COLUMNS "AUTHORIZED ALLOWANCE" AND "BALANCE" SHOULD BE EXTENDED IN PENCIL AND CORRECTED AS CHANGES OCCUR.

ARMY REGULATIONS 35-5440, 15-0120, 35-1500 AND 615-47.

INDIVIDUAL CLOTHING AND EQUIPMENT RECORD

ARTICLES QUARTERMASTER INDIVIDUAL CLOTHING	AUTHORIZED ALLOWANCES	SIZES	DATE / E.M. / O.	ISSUED	TURNED IN	BALANCE
BELT, WEB, WAIST, F.W.	1	36	26 Aug	1		
BOOT, SERVICE, COMBAT			E.M. JHB			
CAP, FIELD, COTTON, O.D.			O. HH			
CAP, GARRISON, EMBL	1	7⅛				
CAP, GARRISON, F.O.	1	7⅛		1		
CAP, HEATHELL	1			1		
COAT, MACKINAW, O.D.						
COAT, WOOL, SERG., O.D.						
DRAWERS, COTTON, SHORTS	3	36		3		
DRAWERS, WOOL	2	34		2		
GLOVES, WOOL, O.D.	1	8		1		
HANDKERCHIEF, COTTON	4			4		
HELMET, STEEL, M-1						
INSIGNIA, COLLAR, F.W.						
INSIGNIA, COLLAR, "U.S." F.W.						
INSIGNIA, SHOULDER-SLEEVE						
INSIGNIA, SLEEVE, CHEVRON, GRADE						
INSIGNIA, SLEEVE, TECH SPECIALIST						
JACKET, FIELD, M-43	1	34R		1		
JACKET, HEATHELL	1	36R		1		
LEGGING, CANVAS, SEMI	1			1		
LINER, HELMET, M-1, COMPLETE						
NECKTIE, COTTON, HERRING, GRAY	2	2R		2		
OVERCOAT, WOOL, O.D.						
OVERSHOES, ARCTIC						
RAINCOAT, SHELL OR MTR	1	S				
SHIRT, COTTON, KHAKI	3	15-33				
SHIRT, FLANNEL, O.D.	2	15-33				
SHOES, SERVICE	2	8C				
SOCK, COTTON, TAN	3	10½				
SOCK, WOOL, COTTON SOLE						
SOCK, WOOL, HEAVY OR LIGHT	3	11				
SUIT, KHAKI, 1-PC, HEATHELL						
SWEATER, HIGH NECK						
TROUSERS, COTTON, KHAKI	3	34-31				
TROUSERS, FIELD, COTTON, O.D.						
TROUSERS, HEATHELL	1	34-31				
TROUSERS, WOOL	2	34-31				
UNDERSHIRT, COTTON	3	38				
UNDERSHIRT, WOOL	2	38				

W. D. A. G. O. FORM NO. 20 8 MAR 1944

(THIS FORM SUPERSEDES W. D. A. G. O. FORM NO. 21 16 FEBRUARY 1942 AND NO. 22 19 MAY 1942 AND NO. 24 19 JANUARY 1943 WHICH WILL NOT BE USED AFTER RECEIPT OF THIS REVISION.)

SERVICE COMMAND UNIT NO. 1112, R.C. Fort Devens, Mass.
Summary of the quantities of articles of clothing and equipme

1. I certify that I have received all the articles of clothing and equipment listed in column #2 except where changed opposite my name.

NAME	Class No.	27-1 Towels, Lava	85-B Brushes, Shaving	79-C Brushes, Tooth	79-K Comb	51-S Razors, safety	55-C Soap, toilet	55-C Cup, wool, serge	55-J Dawers, cotton	55-J Jackets, wool	55-J Jackets, E.F.
2. Al'ance per man (AR 615-40)		2	1	1	1	1	1	1	3	2	1
Richard C Peters											
George B Prentice											
James A Brown											
Frank O. Jones											

Airmens issue records showing stock numbers, nomenclature, and clothing breakdowns. These essentially provided an asset list when found.